

Filip Bircanin

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Summary — I am an HCI researcher–designer who unifies inclusive, accessible, and service design for public-good digital projects. I specialise in co- and participatory design with disadvantaged groups, translating lived experience into actionable frameworks, patterns, and service blueprints. I link discovery and co-creation to prototyping, service integration, and adoption playbooks - so teams can implement and sustain impact.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Human-Computer Interaction Brisbane, Australia
Queensland University of Technology, Advisor: Prof [Margot Brereton](#) 2017–2022
– Project Title: [Co-designing with Adults with Moderate to Severe Intellectual Disabilities to Enable Active Communication Technology Use](#)

Master in Cognitive Science Vienna, Austria
University of Vienna 2014–2017
– Thesis Project: [EDA-based Detection of Empathic Accuracy](#)

WORK EXPERIENCE

King's College London UK
Principal Investigator 2025–Current
– [Include +](#) (An Aphasia-Led Toolkit for Navigating Public Services)
– A lead on a charity-embedded, co-design programme with post-stroke survivor, SLTs, and HCI researchers to map barriers in public-service access and deliver an aphasia-friendly low-tech toolkit

King's College London UK
Principal Researcher 2024–Current
– [Ca11y](#) ([New Investigator Award](#))
– Collaborating with Aphasia charities and BBC R&D to develop and evaluate innovative, flexible media technologies -enhancing digital content accessibility through tailored audiovisual solutions .

Career Break 2023–2024
Family reasons

Centre of Excellence for the Digital Child Brisbane, QUT
Research Fellow Jul 2022 - April 2023
– Empowering Families: Technology's Impact on Communication, Leisure, and Education for Children with Intellectual Disabilities

- UX Fundamentals; Interaction and Experience Design; Interaction Design for Human-Centred AI

Inclusive Design Lab

Brisbane, QUT

2021

- Design, development and deployment

IMG Norway and Institute for Social Protection

Belgrade, Serbia

2012-2014

- Diversionary Measures – Integrative Treatment Programme for Children in Conflict with Law

Centre for Youth Integration

Belgrade, Serbia

2005–2011

- Leadership: Assistant Coordinator (Drop-in Centre) and Programme Coordinator (Outreach); supervised and mentored multidisciplinary staff; initiated annual service-improvement cycles using user studies and needs assessments.
- Service design / Innovation:
 - * New services: opened two new drop-in centres serving additional city districts; launched national first *Big Issue*-style street paper;
 - * Mental-health pathways: created referral routes with municipal clinics; introduced in-house supports (art-therapy; DBT groups) for street-connected youth.
 - * Undocumented children: developed intake standards and advocacy protocols enabling access to social/health care for children without IDs.
 - * Outreach model: designed/piloted social street-worker role; authored end-to-end national standards for outreach within the social-welfare system.
 - * Systems mapping: current→future-state journeys across social work, health, education, and justice; roles, hand-offs, and value exchanges; service blueprints.
 - * Prototyping & pilots: tested touchpoints (forms, scripts, evidence flows) across physical/digital/human interfaces; scaled those with clear feasibility, and viability.
- Partnerships: coordinated with municipal services, NGOs, and Social Welfare Gov Services; built referral pathways and follow-up routines.

Check my [website](#) for more projects

SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE

User Research Methods

- [Discovery & framing](#): contextual/ethnographic interviews (structured/semistructured/unstructured), participant observation, diary studies, cultural probes, desk research, Double Diamond (Discover→Define), [Field-theory framing](#).
- [Generative & co-design](#): co-design workshops, speculative design/design fiction, storyboards, empathy mapping, personas.
- [Mapping & synthesis](#): journey mapping, service blueprints, card sorting & tree testing, affinity clustering, thematic analysis, segmentation.

- **Prototyping:** low→high-fidelity (paper, wireframes, clickable, coded), Wizard-of-Oz(WoZ) simulations, Research through Design (RtD) artefacts; in-the-wild deployments.
- **Evaluation:** think-aloud, task-based usability (moderated/unmoderated), heuristic reviews, first-click/success rates, SUS, NASA-TLX.
- **Quant & analytics:** survey/instrument design, descriptive & inferential stats, log/app analytics, field pilots (A/B-style), use-metrics.
- **Inclusive methods:** CCN-friendly protocols (aphasia); plain-language, pictorial & audio alternatives; supported conversation; pacing/breaks; ethics & safeguarding.

Recent examples:

AudioVisual Media Accessibility

2 home trials - working prototype, diary/photo elicitation study, triangulation, use analytics: log, metrics, visual traces, Vignettes and LikertScale Questionnaires

Accessible Public Services

Co-Design; Focus groups; Thematic Analysis; Card Sorting - A deck designed from scratch (cluster analysis); Design Fictions (Audio Prompts); pathway (journey) mapping; Web Progressive prototype development

Inclusive Research & Ethics

- Participatory design with CCN and intellectual disabilities: co-design in care settings; AAC prototyping.
- Digital Child Ethics Toolkit development (templates, checklists, guidance); authored [guidance](#) on granular participation reporting and enabling children's agency earlier in design.
- Led sensitive, in-home disability research: robust consent, safeguarding, and accessible friendly materials.

Analysis & Synthesis

- Qualitative depth: reflexive thematic; narrative; conversation/EM interaction; multimodal interaction; affinity mapping; extensive NVivo use across 500+ hours.
- Quant methods: EDA analytics—tonic/phasic split, SCR detection & counts (IIR high-pass, thresholded peaks), EDAAffect Dial synchrony (Pearson r); assumption checks (Q-Q/normality) & independent t-tests; survey statistics — developing stakeholder questionnaires (social care, police, NGOs; n=182), Likert-scale summaries & descriptive stats; plus use-metrics in field deployments.

Service Design

- End-to-end: discovery → delivery; journey mapping, pain points, eligibility gates, handoffs.
- Blueprinting: front/backstage roles, SLAs, data flows, escalation paths.
- Evidence & triage: intake criteria, risk/needs assessment, prioritisation; consent & safeguarding patterns.
- Co-design & testing: workshops; service prototypes; scripts/forms/comms templates; rapid pilots.

- Implementation: SOPs, training & onboarding, change management; partner alignment.
- M&E: KPIs, dashboards, learning reviews; outcome evaluation and continuous improvement.

Agile Research Practice & Delivery

- Translating findings into backlog items with acceptance criteria; rapid iteration to inform go/no-go in time-boxed programmes (e.g., [Advokit](#) – 5-month study delivering a paper + working prototype).
- Produced service maps and working prototype using RtD + Agile; shipped testable [UI multimodal patterns](#)(read-along highlighting, tiered summaries, speed control, context look-ups) that reduce cognitive load and improve comprehension post-stroke.

Research Management & Leadership

- PI of a national public-service accessibility project (£50k; 6-person team; 20+ end-users): ethics, recruitment, delivery, publication pathway.
- Principal Researcher on a 2-year media-accessibility programme: study design, recruitment, methods, data collection/analysis, team leadership, dissemination; 5 peer-reviewed papers (2025).
- Early-career leadership: coordinated cross-national research with ombudsman offices, councils, NGOs, institutions; authored a 90-page report with 12 guidelines (policy changes) adopted in national guidance.

Stakeholder Management / Interdisciplinarity

- Worked with government departments (ie., Institute for Social Welfare and protection), ombudsman offices (Children’s Ombudsman), broadcasters (ie., BBC R/D), NGOs (ie., Endeavour Foundation), charities (Aphasia Re-Connect, Save the children UK) and different ; align user evidence with policy/operational/technical constraints to secure decisions.
- Board-level contribution (Aphasia Re-Connect charity trustee, ongoing); regular engagement with senior stakeholders to set direction while keeping end-user needs central.

Teaching, Mentoring & Community

- 300+ hours HE teaching across 3–4 HCI/UX modules (lectures, tutorials, assessment) with cohorts of 35+; content: prototyping, usability testing, cultural probes, journey/empathy mapping, qualitative methods.
- Co-supervision of two PhD candidates; ongoing mentoring on methods, ethics, and analysis.

Evidence of Impact

- AAC system adopted by a large NGO across three learning & lifestyle centres (intellectual disabilities).
- Media-accessibility patterns informing broadcaster accessibility roadmaps (collaboration with a major media organisation BBC R/D and iTV Accessibility Team).
- Social-policy research delivered 12 actionable reforms, launched via press conference.
- 9 mid-fidelity systems designed, trialled, and evaluated (open-sourced software & hardware; non-commercial).

Tools & Techniques

- NVivo; Miro; qualitative video/interaction analysis; questionnaire design & basic stats; prototyping (Figma, Progressive Web Apps); instrumentation & evidence planning for app-use data.
- Laser-cutting & 3D-printing fundamentals.
- Python (Jupyter for descriptive/inferential stats); HTML/CSS/JS basics.
- Adobe Suite (Illustrator, Premiere Pro) for prototyping & visualisation.
- Previously used: Taguette, SPSS, R.
- Experienced LLM practitioner (across all cycles) – research, analysis, writing, prototyping, teaching
- Experienced Latex User

★ FUNDING AND AWARDS

• EPSRC (£50,000) - AdvoKit: An Aphasia-Led Toolkit for Navigating Public Services	2025
• CDC (\$19,000) - Developing Inclusive Cultural Probes for Creative Qualitative Inquiry	2023
• King’s Seed Sanctuary Award	2024
• Honorary Lecturer status - Queensland University of Technology	2022–2025
• Honourable Mention Award at CHI’21	2021
• QUTPRA Scholarship Award	2017
• Erasmus Scholarship Award	2015–2015
• Save the Children UK Overseas Award	2010–2010

🌱 PUBLIC GOOD INITIATIVES

• Street Protest “Illuminated” <i>Organiser</i>	2010
• Street Children Network Europe <i>Co-founder</i>	2009
• “Big Issue” Serbia <i>Field Coordinator</i>	2010
• Outdoor Collective <i>Co-Founder</i>	2012

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Aphasia Re-Connect 2024–Current
Board Trustee
- HCClub Chair 2024–Current
Dedicated club for professional development of KCL's PhD and Postdoctoral researchers
- Associate Chair 2022–Current
I regularly volunteer as an Associate Chair for CHI'23, CHI'24, DIS'23, DIS'24
- Digital Wellbeing Lab 2023–2025
Affiliated Researcher
- The Albert Ellis Institute 2023–2025
REBT certified Therapist
- AI Institute, Slovenia 2016/2017
Dedicated club for professional development of KCL's PhD and Postdoctoral researchers
- Justice Academy 2012
TOT Training of Trainers
- TA 101 2009
Transactional Analysis Foundations
- National Child Line 2011
Councillor

PUBLICATIONS

1. Curtis H, Bircanin F., Neate T., **2025**, July. “An Old Bastard in Bright Orange Satin!”: Zuzenna’s Aphasia Diary : And Lessons Learned from DIY Augmentative and Alternative Communication. In The 27th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '25)
 2. Bircanin, F., Sitbon, L., Hoogstrate, M., Abbas, A.K., Hajizadeh Saffar, A. and Brereton, M., **2025**, April. Beyond the Buckets of Support: Designing for Agency and Interaction in Personalised Disability Systems. In Proceedings of the *2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (pp. 1-19).
 3. Bircanin, F., Nevsky, A., Perera, H., Agarwal, V., Song, E., Cruice, M. and Neate, T., **2025**, April. Sounds Accessible: Envisioning Accessible Audio-Media Futures with People with Aphasia. In Proceedings of the *2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (pp. 1-22).
 4. Bircanin, F., Brereton, M., Sitbon, L., Ploderer, B. and Esteban, M., **2025**. Co-designing in the middle: supporting adults with intellectual disabilities to meaningfully participate in design. *CoDesign*, pp.1-21.
 5. Nevsky, A., Bircanin, F., Cruice, M., Simperl, E., and Neate, T., **2025**, April. To Each Their Own: Exploring Highly Personalised Audiovisual Media Accessibility Interventions with People with Aphasia. In Proceedings of the *2025 DIS Designing Interactive Systems Conference*
- CLICK [HERE](#) FOR MORE

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- Conference Presentations (ie., CHI'25 5000 delegates) 2018–2025
Lead Author
- National Press Conference - Ombudsman’s Office and CYI 2011
Main Speaker
- Congress of Serbian Psychotherapists - Presentation/Workshop 2013
Project lead and presenter

- TV and Radio appearances as CYI representative
Programme Coordinator

2006–2011

REPORTS/NATIONAL STANDARDS

1. National Report - Prevention of Exploitation of Children in South East Europe (2011)–available upon request
2. We know best - Practice Guide (2010)–available upon request
3. Non-implementation of the Child Rights in Serbia (2008)–available upon request
4. National minimum Outreach Standards - only available in Serbian (2010)–available upon request